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FREE GUIDE FOR WOMEN 40+

STRONG THROUGH THE CHANGE

The perimenopause & menopause fat loss guide: lose fat, keep your muscle and feel like yourself again.

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PART 1

WHY FAT LOSS FEELS HARDER NOW

If you're eating the same and moving the same but your body feels different, you're not imagining it, and you haven't lost your willpower. During perimenopause and menopause your hormones shift, and that changes how your body stores fat, builds muscle and recovers.

Oestrogen drops

Lower oestrogen tends to move fat storage towards the belly, and can make you less sensitive to insulin.

Muscle slips away

We naturally lose muscle with age, and it speeds up now. Less muscle means you burn less energy every day.

Sleep gets disrupted

Night sweats and waking at 3am leave you tired, which drives up hunger and cravings the next day.

Stress hits harder

Mood swings, anxiety and a busy life all add up, making it harder to stay consistent.

THE GOOD NEWS

The old approach of eating less and doing more cardio usually backfires now. What works is simpler: **enough protein, lifting weights, a gentle calorie deficit, and protecting your sleep**. The rest of this guide shows you exactly how.

PART 2

EAT TO KEEP YOUR MUSCLE

Forget crash diets. Cutting calories hard makes you lose muscle, which is the last thing you need now. Aim for a small, steady deficit and build every meal around these five habits.

1

Protein at every meal

Aim for a palm-to-hand-sized portion (roughly 25–40g) three or four times a day: eggs, Greek yoghurt, chicken, fish, lean meat, tofu, lentils. It protects muscle and keeps you full.

2

A gentle deficit, not a crash diet

A small daily deficit you can stick to beats a harsh one you quit after two weeks. Slow and steady keeps your energy, mood and muscle intact.

3

Half your plate from plants

Vegetables, fruit, beans and wholegrains bring fibre for fullness, gut health and steadier blood sugar.

4

Look after your bones

Include calcium-rich foods daily (dairy or fortified alternatives, tinned fish with bones, leafy greens). In the UK, a vitamin D supplement is recommended in autumn and winter.

5

Go easy on alcohol

Alcohol adds empty calories, worsens sleep and can trigger hot flushes. Cutting back is one of the fastest wins.

BUILD YOUR PLATE

½ plate	¼ plate	¼ plate	Thumb
Veg & salad	Protein	Smart carbs	Healthy fats

PART 3

LIFT WEIGHTS. WALK MORE.

Strength training is the single best thing you can do right now. It rebuilds muscle, strengthens your bones, improves blood sugar control and lifts your mood. You don't need hours: three 40-minute sessions a week is plenty.

WORKOUT A

Exercise	Sets × reps
Goblet squat	3 × 8–12
Dumbbell chest press	3 × 8–12
Seated cable row	3 × 10–12
Glute bridge	3 × 12–15
Plank	3 × 20–40s

WORKOUT B

Exercise	Sets × reps
Romanian deadlift	3 × 8–12
Lat pulldown	3 × 10–12
Reverse lunge	3 × 8 each
Shoulder press	3 × 10–12
Farmer's carry	3 × 30m

How to run it: alternate A and B (e.g. Mon A, Wed B, Fri A). Pick a weight where the last 2 reps feel hard but your form stays clean. When you hit the top of the rep range on every set, go a little heavier.

WALK DAILY

Build up towards 7,000–10,000 steps a day. Walking burns more energy across the week than most workouts, without spiking stress.

NEW TO LIFTING?

Start with 2 sets and light weights for the first two weeks. If you have joint problems or a health condition, check with your GP first.

PART 4

SLEEP, STRESS & SYMPTOMS

Poor sleep and high stress make fat loss feel impossible: you're hungrier, crave sugar and have less energy to train. Small changes here make everything else easier.

Better sleep

- Same bed and wake time, even at weekends
- Keep the bedroom cool, with light layers
- No caffeine after midday
- Screens off 30–60 minutes before bed
- Limit alcohol, especially in the evening

Lower stress

- A 10–20 minute walk outdoors daily
- Five minutes of slow breathing before bed
- Say no to one thing a week
- Talk to friends going through it too
- Book time for yourself like an appointment

Managing hot flushes

Common triggers include alcohol, caffeine, spicy food, hot drinks and stress. Keep a simple note for two weeks to spot yours. Regular exercise and keeping a healthy weight can also help reduce how often they happen.

TALK TO YOUR GP

If symptoms are affecting your daily life, speak to your GP about your options, including HRT. It isn't a fat loss treatment, but easing symptoms like poor sleep and low mood can make it far easier to stay consistent. This guide is general advice and doesn't replace medical care.

PART 5

YOUR 7-DAY KICKSTART

Add one new habit each day and keep the ones before it. By day 7 you'll have the whole foundation in place. Tick each one off as you go.

DAY 1	Add a palm of protein to breakfast.	☐
DAY 2	Take a 20-minute walk and note your step count.	☐
DAY 3	Do Workout A from Part 3, even at light weights.	☐
DAY 4	Build every meal using the plate guide: half veg, a quarter protein.	☐
DAY 5	Set a fixed bedtime and switch screens off 30 minutes before.	☐
DAY 6	Do Workout B, then plan next week's three sessions in your diary.	☐
DAY 7	Review the week: what felt easy, what was hard, and one thing to improve.	☐

TRACK WHAT MATTERS

The scales can bounce around during this stage of life. Measure your waist once a week, take photos every four weeks, and notice your energy and strength too.



MEET YOUR COACH

CRAIG RHYS PRICE

I'm an online fitness coach helping people over 40 lose fat, get strong and feel confident again, without extreme diets or living in the gym.

I've watched so many women feel like their body has turned against them: doing everything right, yet feeling tired, heavier and frustrated. If that's you, I want you to know it isn't your fault, and it isn't too late. My approach is patient and realistic, built around your symptoms and your life. Some weeks will be harder than others, and that's okay. Keep showing up, and the results will come.

CLIENT RESULT

"There were weeks I nearly quit, but Craig kept me going. I'm stronger, I've lost the belly fat and I feel like me again. I'm so glad I didn't give up."

WANT THIS DONE FOR YOU?

My coaching gives you a plan built around your body, your symptoms and your schedule, with weekly check-ins so you never feel on your own.

Book your free call: [YOUR BOOKING LINK]

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